ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Reporting verb patterns

Control the complementation patterns that follow reporting verbs such as admit, deny, advise, warn, promise and suggest. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use reporting verb patterns to report speech while preserving whether it was advice, refusal, admission, warning or commitment while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Control the complementation patterns that follow reporting verbs such as admit, deny, advise, warn, promise and suggest.

MODEL

The consultant advised us to delay the launch.

verb + -ing | verb + object + to-infinitive | verb + that-clause

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main reporting verb patterns patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses report speech while preserving whether it was advice, refusal, admission, warning or commitment.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in news, minutes, academic summaries and everyday retelling.

Build meaning before form

Control the complementation patterns that follow reporting verbs such as admit, deny, advise, warn, promise and suggest.

What reporting verb patterns communicates

Control the complementation patterns that follow reporting verbs such as admit, deny, advise, warn, promise and suggest.

The central purpose is to report speech while preserving whether it was advice, refusal, admission, warning or commitment. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The manager admitted overlooking the warning.	an admission or report focused on an action
The consultant advised us to delay the launch.	advice or influence directed at a specific person
The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.	a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: verb + -ing | verb + object + to-infinitive | verb + that-clause. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “The consultant advised us to delay the launch.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Gerund report	admit/deny/suggest + -ing	The manager admitted overlooking the warning.
Object plus infinitive	advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive	The consultant advised us to delay the launch.
That-clause	promise/claim/confirm + that-clause	The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
an admission or report focused on an action	Gerund report
advice or influence directed at a specific person	Object plus infinitive
a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation	That-clause

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in news, minutes, academic summaries and everyday retelling. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04	05	06	07
verb	-ing	verb	object	to-infinitive	verb	that-clause

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: report speech while preserving whether it was advice, refusal, admission, warning or commitment.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits news, minutes, academic summaries and everyday retelling.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Gerund report	admit/deny/suggest + -ing	The manager admitted overlooking the warning.
Object plus infinitive	advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive	The consultant advised us to delay the launch.
That-clause	promise/claim/confirm + that-clause	The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The manager admitted overlooking the warning.	an admission or report focused on an action
The consultant advised us to delay the launch.	advice or influence directed at a specific person
The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.	a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use an object plus to-infinitive after admit or deny.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not omit the object when the reporting verb requires one.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not backshift automatically when the information remains current and the context favours no shift.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an admission or report focused on an action?

OPTIONS The manager admitted overlooking the warning. · The consultant advised us to delay the launch. · The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: advice or influence directed at a specific person?

OPTIONS The consultant advised us to delay the launch. · The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock. · The manager admitted overlooking the warning.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation?

OPTIONS The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock. · The manager admitted overlooking the warning. · The consultant advised us to delay the launch.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The manager admitted overlooking the warning.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an admission or report focused on an action · advice or influence directed at a specific person · a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The consultant advised us to delay the launch.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS advice or influence directed at a specific person · a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation · an admission or report focused on an action

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation · an admission or report focused on an action · advice or influence directed at a specific person

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"The manager admitted overlooking the warning." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Gerund report / Object plus infinitive / That-clause · Gap 2: an admission or report focused on an action / advice or influence directed at a specific person / a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"The consultant advised us to delay the launch." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Object plus infinitive / That-clause / Gerund report · Gap 2: advice or influence directed at a specific person / a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation / an admission or report focused on an action

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: That-clause / Gerund report / Object plus infinitive · Gap 2: a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation / an admission or report focused on an action / advice or influence directed at a specific person

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses an admission or report focused on an action: _____. Choose the model that expresses advice or influence directed at a specific person: _____. Choose the model that expresses a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation: _____. Choose the model built with admit/deny/suggest + -ing: _____. Choose the model built with advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive: _____. Choose the model built with promise/claim/confirm + that-clause: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The consultant advised us to delay the launch. · The manager admitted overlooking the warning. · The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The manager _____ the warning. The consultant _____ the launch. The supplier _____ the parts were in stock. State the full structural pattern for Gerund report: _____. State the full structural pattern for Object plus infinitive: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The manager said that she had overlooked the warning.” using the Gerund report pattern to express an admission or report focused on an action.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The consultant told us that delaying was advisable.” using the Object plus infinitive pattern to express advice or influence directed at a specific person.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The supplier said the parts were available.” using the That-clause pattern to express a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The manager said that she had overlooked the warning.” using the Gerund report pattern to express an admission or report focused on an action.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Gerund report to express an admission or report focused on an action, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Object plus infinitive to express advice or influence directed at a specific person, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use That-clause to express a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The manager admitted overlooking the warning.

Gerund report is the best match because an admission or report focused on an action.

A2

The consultant advised us to delay the launch.

Object plus infinitive is the best match because advice or influence directed at a specific person.

A3

The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

That-clause is the best match because a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation.

A4

an admission or report focused on an action

The Gerund report pattern communicates an admission or report focused on an action.

A5

advice or influence directed at a specific person

The Object plus infinitive pattern communicates advice or influence directed at a specific person.

A6

a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation

The That-clause pattern communicates a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Gerund report / an admission or report focused on an action

The structure belongs to the Gerund report pattern. Its communicative purpose is an admission or report focused on an action.

B2

Object plus infinitive / advice or influence directed at a specific person

The structure belongs to the Object plus infinitive pattern. Its communicative purpose is advice or influence directed at a specific person.

B3

That-clause / a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation

The structure belongs to the That-clause pattern. Its communicative purpose is a proposition reported as a claim, promise or confirmation.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The manager admitted overlooking the warning.

Gerund report: admit/deny/suggest + -ing.

C2

The consultant advised us to delay the launch.

Object plus infinitive: advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive.

C3

The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

That-clause: promise/claim/confirm + that-clause.

C4

The manager admitted overlooking the warning.

Gerund report: admit/deny/suggest + -ing.

C5

The consultant advised us to delay the launch.

Object plus infinitive: advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive.

C6

The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

That-clause: promise/claim/confirm + that-clause.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

admitted overlooking

Gerund report requires “admitted overlooking” in this model. admit/deny/suggest + -ing.

D2

advised us to delay

Object plus infinitive requires “advised us to delay” in this model. advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive.

D3

confirmed that

That-clause requires “confirmed that” in this model. promise/claim/confirm + that-clause.

D4

admit/deny/suggest + -ing

Gerund report is built as admit/deny/suggest + -ing.

D5

advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive

Object plus infinitive is built as advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The manager admitted overlooking the warning.

admit/deny/suggest + -ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended gerund report effect.

E2

The consultant advised us to delay the launch.

advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended object plus infinitive effect.

E3

The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock.

promise/claim/confirm + that-clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended that-clause effect.

E4

The manager admitted overlooking the warning.

admit/deny/suggest + -ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended gerund report effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The manager admitted overlooking the warning. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses admit/deny/suggest + -ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The consultant advised us to delay the launch. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses advise/warn/remind + object + to-infinitive accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The supplier confirmed that the parts were in stock. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses promise/claim/confirm + that-clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____